

B P G Ö NEWS

BUND PHILIPPINISCHER GESUNDHEITSKRÄFTE ÖSTERREICH

25.July.2025

barrio fiesta 2025

A COLORFUL CELEBRATION OF FILIPINO CULTURE IN THE HEART OF VIENNA

BY: REXIL BORDAJE

Barrio Fiesta Highlights - First Aiders

Filipino Health Professionals
in Upper Austria

Photos



The vibrant spirit of Filipino heritage came alive once again during the much-anticipated Barrio Fiesta 2025, held on July 19 at ATV Leasing Sportplatz in Vienna's 23rd district. With its familiar blend of festive energy, mouthwatering delicacies, and cultural pride, the event drew an overwhelming crowd from across Austria—and beyond.

Barrio Fiesta, a traditional Filipino community gathering, is more than just a feast—it's a celebration of togetherness, resilience, and rich cultural identity.

The venue at Franz Heidergasse 14 / Pellmangasse 2 was filled with laughter,

music, and the irresistible aroma of lechon, pancit, kakanin, and other beloved Filipino dishes. Colorful decorations reminiscent of a classic Philippine town fiesta added to the atmosphere, transporting attendees straight to the islands.

People from all walks of life came together—Filipino families, Austrian locals, and even international guests—showcasing the beauty of multicultural harmony. Attendees wore traditional Filipino attire, performed folk dances, sang kundiman songs, and played parlor games, creating a joyful and nostalgic celebration of Filipino roots.



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The event featured food booths from various regional groups and individuals, each offering a homemade taste of the Philippines. From adobo and sinigang to bibingka and halo-halo, every bite told a story of home. Community members also took the opportunity to showcase crafts, small businesses, and local services, promoting Filipino entrepreneurship in Austria.

One of the day's highlights was the cultural show, where performers of all ages graced the stage with traditional dances like Tinikling, Pandanggo sa Ilaw, and modern Filipino-Austrian fusions, reflecting the evolving yet rooted identity of the diaspora community.

Most importantly, the Barrio Fiesta reaffirmed the unity and strength of the Filipino community in Austria. As many participants shared, the event wasn't just a celebration—it was a way to reconnect with their roots, build bridges with other cultures, and pass on traditions to younger generations.

With its success, Barrio Fiesta 2025 stands as a shining example of how Filipino culture continues to thrive abroad. The warmth, hospitality, and bayanihan (community spirit) that define the Filipino identity were on full display, reminding everyone present that even far from home, the heart of the Philippines beats strong.

Mabuhay ang kulturang Pilipino sa Austria!



BPGÖ proudly served as the official First Aider Station during the Barrio Fiesta 2025, under the leadership of **Vice President Daniel Garces** and **Treasurer Malou Bauer**. With dedication and teamwork, BPGÖ members and volunteers worked hand in hand to provide medical support and care to attendees in need, ensuring a safe and well-supported celebration for everyone. Special thanks to **Ms. Karel Cabanting** for her initiative in preparing the duty schedule for each first aider in advance and for taking full responsibility for the necessary paperwork required by the Bund. Our sincere appreciation also goes to BPGÖ **President Marjorie Akistoy** for providing essential materials that greatly contributed to the success of our first aid operations during the event.

We are deeply grateful to **Wie Daham**, our main sponsor, for their generous support in making BPGÖ's service as first aid responders possible. Your support helped ensure a safe and enjoyable celebration for all.





A Remarkable Celebration

Vice President Daniel Garces

A significant number of Austria's Filipino community gathered for Barrio Fiesta 2025, a truly outstanding event made possible by the hard work of the CFAA organizers—our heartfelt thanks to them. The BPGÖ proudly served as the official first aid response team, professionally managing several medical situations on-site. The skilled support from our nurses across various Austrian federal states was invaluable.

I sincerely commend every team member for their dedication and professionalism, which allowed guests to fully enjoy the festivities. Special thanks go to Mrs. Malou Bauer for the wonderful catering, Mrs. Karel for effectively coordinating the duty schedule, and Mr. Rexil Bordaje for overseeing on-site operations. This outstanding team has once again shown its ability to face any challenge, and we look forward to continued collaboration in serving our Filipino community.

Unity in Diversity

Upper Austria's Filipino Healthcare Workers Gather in Celebration of Culture and Community

Filipino healthcare professionals in Upper Austria came together to celebrate the vibrant Barrio Fiesta. Nurses from across the region participated under the guidance of advisor Janet Heiss. The event was also graced by the presence of the organization's president, Mary Avancena, along with several officers who showed their support and unity during the celebration.



